

Melbourne Sustainable Start

A peer-led everyday sustainability guide for international students in Melbourne

Helping students make low-waste, low-carbon choices practical, culturally accessible and less intimidating.

THE PROBLEM

Many international students care about sustainability, but practising it in a new city can feel confusing. Food shopping, shared kitchens, rental routines, Myki, waste systems, budgets, language and cultural norms all shape what feels possible.

THE PROJECT IDEA

Create peer-led resources and workshops that help international students start with everyday choices: reducing food waste, using low-carbon transport and making more thoughtful consumption decisions.

Three everyday starting points

Small, practical entry points that can be tested with peers and improved through feedback.

Food waste

- Shopping tips
- Shared meal ideas
- Leftover use
- Low-cost cooking
- "Use first" fridge habits

Transport

- Myki confidence
- Low-carbon trip planning
- Public transport routines
- Walking and cycling confidence

Consumption

- Second-hand options
- Borrowing and sharing
- Buying less on a student budget
- Sustainable student living

EXAMPLE RESOURCE

5-step food waste starter

- 1 Plan two simple meals before shopping.
- 2 Buy ingredients that work across multiple dishes.
- 3 Share bulk items with housemates or friends.
- 4 Keep a "use first" area in the fridge.
- 5 Turn leftovers into one flexible meal each week.

WORKSHOP PROTOTYPE

Sustainable Student Living in Melbourne

A peer-led 45-60 minute session where students share everyday barriers, learn practical strategies and leave with one habit to test.

- 10 min What feels confusing?
- 15 min Food waste and low-cost meals
- 15 min Transport and consumption choices
- 10 min Choose one habit to test
- 10 min Feedback and next steps

HOW I WOULD TEST IT THROUGH WATTLE

1

Listen

Speak with students →

2

Prototype

Create a guide →

3

Pilot

Run one workshop →

4

Improve

Adapt with feedback

Success measure: Students feel more confident, less overwhelmed and more able to take one practical step.